

UX/UI
Case study

CIRCA

Book Rental App
Borrow. Read. Return



About the project

Circa offers a simple and secure solution to help people read more at a lower cost. It connects book owners with readers, making it easier to access books without the need to buy them, turning unused books into shared value, while encouraging a culture of reading and community exchange



Book sharing

Easily rent or borrow books from nearby users, turning unused books into valuable shared resources

Secure Transactions

A deposit system and user ratings ensure trust and protect both book owners and borrowers

Borrow tracking

Track borrowing duration, due dates, and returns to keep everything organized and stress-free

Before we dive in,

Meet the Circa Creators



**Hager
Tamer**



**Eyad
Fouad**



**Seif
Al-Din**



**Ganna
Hossam**



**Farida
Nabil**



**Shams
Farrag**



Problem Statement

Problem

Many readers struggle to access books due to high prices and limited availability.



Gap

There is no single platform that connects readers with both libraries and individuals for easy book renting.



Solution

A mobile app that enables users to discover and rent books from nearby libraries or individuals.

Research goals



Understand User Behavior

Define Target Audience

Enhance User Experience

Identify User Pain Points

Analyze Market & Competitors

Identify Key Features

Design Thinking Process



Empathize

researched for readers and book owners to understand their needs. Renters want affordable, short-term access to books, while owners are concerned about trust, damage, and reliability when lending.



Define

Users need a way to rent books from others that is affordable and secure.
Problem: How might we create a trusted system for peer-to-peer book rentals?



Ideate

Exploring solutions focused on building trust, such as verified profiles, ratings, deposits, clear rental periods, and in-app communication.



Prototype

Designing wireframes and UI screens covering browsing, book details, booking, and rental management, with a focus on simplicity and trust signals.

Key Insights

Understanding use behavior & Pain points



01 High Book Prices

A significant number of users are discouraged from buying books due to high prices



02 Preference for Flexible Access

Users prefer a hybrid model that allows both buying and borrowing instead of committing to just one option.



03 Trust Issues in Book Borrowing

The main challenges in borrowing are poor book condition and lack of trust between users.



04 Demand for an All-in-One Book Platform

There is a strong need for a single platform that provides easy access to books along with additional services.

Persona

USER PERSONA : LAYLA AHMED

NAME: Layla Ahmed | **AGE:** 25

OCCUPATION: Digital Marketing Specialist & Avid Reader

LOCATION: Giza, Egypt

GOALS: Discover unique and diverse books, manage her reading queue, save costs compared to purchasing new books.

PAIN POINTS: Difficulty finding out-of-print

BIO: LAYLA is a passionate marketer and a dedicated reader who values curated selections and cost-effective access to diverse literature. She use "CIRCA" to manage her reading list and explore new genres.



20s

Empathy Map



Thinks

- How can I read more books without spending too much?
- Is this app reliable and safe to use?
- Will I find the books I'm interested in?
- Is the renting process easy and convenient?



Sees

- How can I read more books without spending too much?
- Is this app reliable and safe to use?
- Will I find the books I'm interested in?
- Is the renting process easy and convenient?



Hears

- Recommendations from friends and classmates
- Book reviews and opinions from influencers
- Comments about book rental experiences
- Advice to save money by renting instead of buying



Layla



Says

- "Books are too expensive to buy."
- "I wish there was an easier way to find the books I want."
- "I don't always have space to keep books."
- "I hope the rented book will be in good condition."



Does

- Searches for books online
- Compares prices and options
- Reads reviews before renting
- Adds books to wishlist
- Rents books and returns on time

Future Feature: Digital Reading

To enhance the user experience, we plan to introduce digital reading within the application. Users will be able to rent or purchase e-books and read them directly inside the app anytime, anywhere. This feature expands our platform beyond physical rentals and creates a more flexible, accessible, and complete reading experience.

Feature List



Digital Book Reading Inside App
Read rented or purchased books seamlessly within the application.



Audiobook Mode
Enjoy books through integrated audio playback for hands-free reading.



Reading Progress Tracker
Track reading progress, completed chapters, and personal reading goals.



Offline Reading
Download books and continue reading without an internet connection

Competitors analysis

We analyzed the existing competition (direct & indirect) both local and global by evaluating their unique features, strategies and app design to help guide the research in the direction of the most suitable solutions for potential users.

- Physical Book Lending
- Trusted User Profile
- Modern UI/UX
- Secure Payment/Fees

	goodreads	Local book club	 iBooks
✓	✗	✗	✓
✓	✗	✗	✗
✓	✗	✗	✗
✓	✗	✗	✓



	goodreads	Local book club	 iBooks
Pros • seamless peer-to-peer lending • Modern UI/UX to keep pace with today's user experience • Trust-based profiles cons • Smaller initial book catalog	Pros • Massive data and reviews cons • No physical lending • Outdated UI	Pros • Personal connections cons • Manual tracking, Limited reach	Pros • integrated digital library cons • Digital only • No social lending

Brand Identity



We developed a Book sharing community system and choosed CIRCA as its closed circuit between the Borrower and the Lender.
The logo is more expressive as a closed circuit Book community.
Blue and gray were used to express the meaning of safety and evokes a sense of ease.

Aa

Typeface —→ Berlin Sans FB

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#2062D3

#0B176E

#2875F7

#F7F7F9

Brand Identity

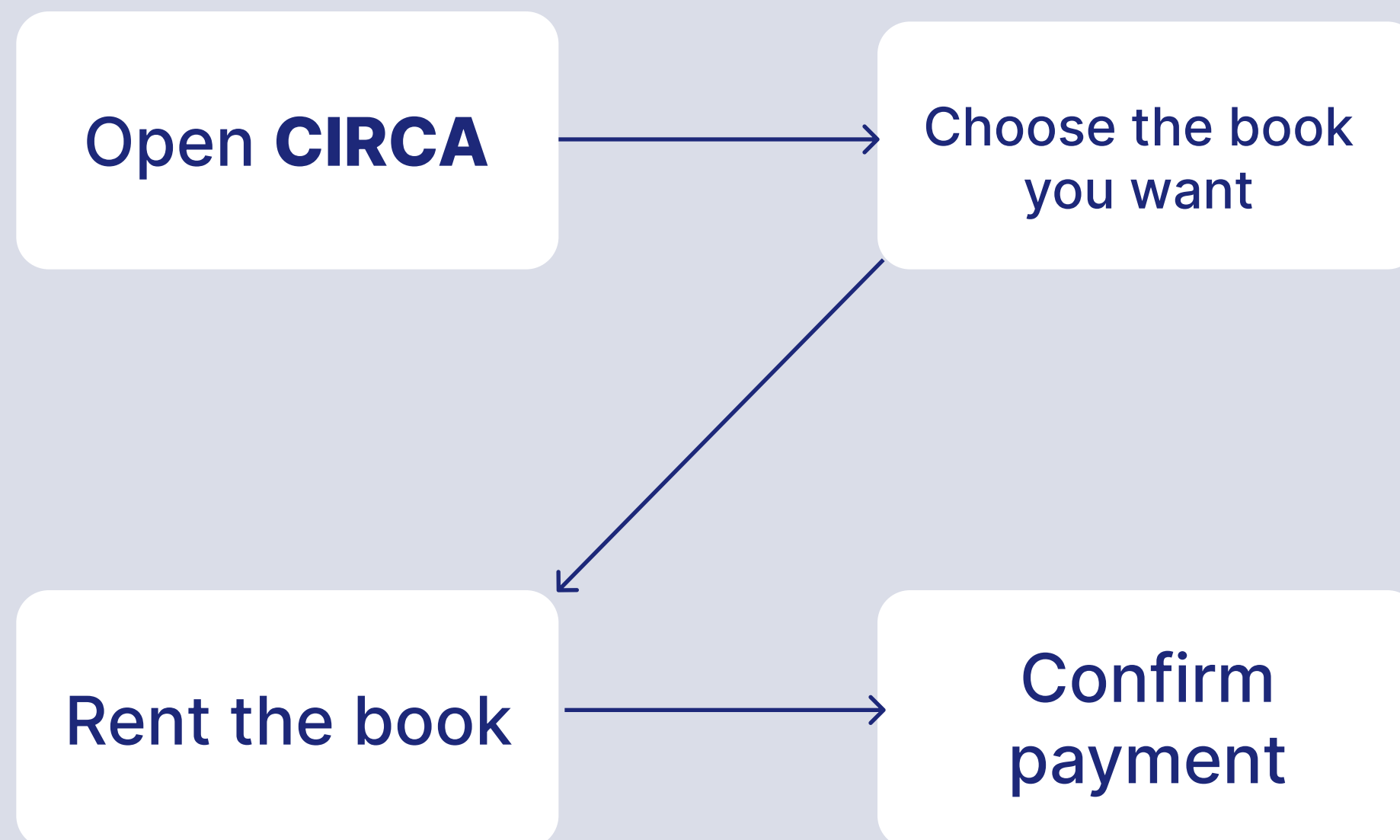
Packaging



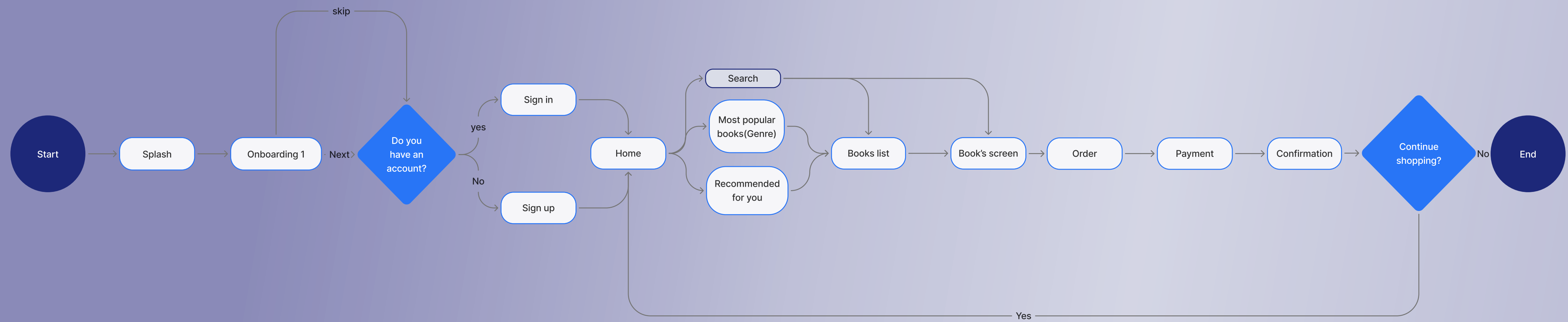
User flow



The user flow of the application was designed to be clear, intuitive, and easy to follow for a wide range of users. From browsing available books and libraries to booking tickets and completing the overall cinema experience, each step is structured to minimize confusion and reduce effort. We focused on creating a smooth and seamless journey by applying fundamental user experience (UX) principles such as simplicity, consistency, and clarity. This ensures that users can navigate the app efficiently, complete their tasks easily, and enjoy a comfortable and engaging experience without unnecessary complexity.



User flow



App Icon

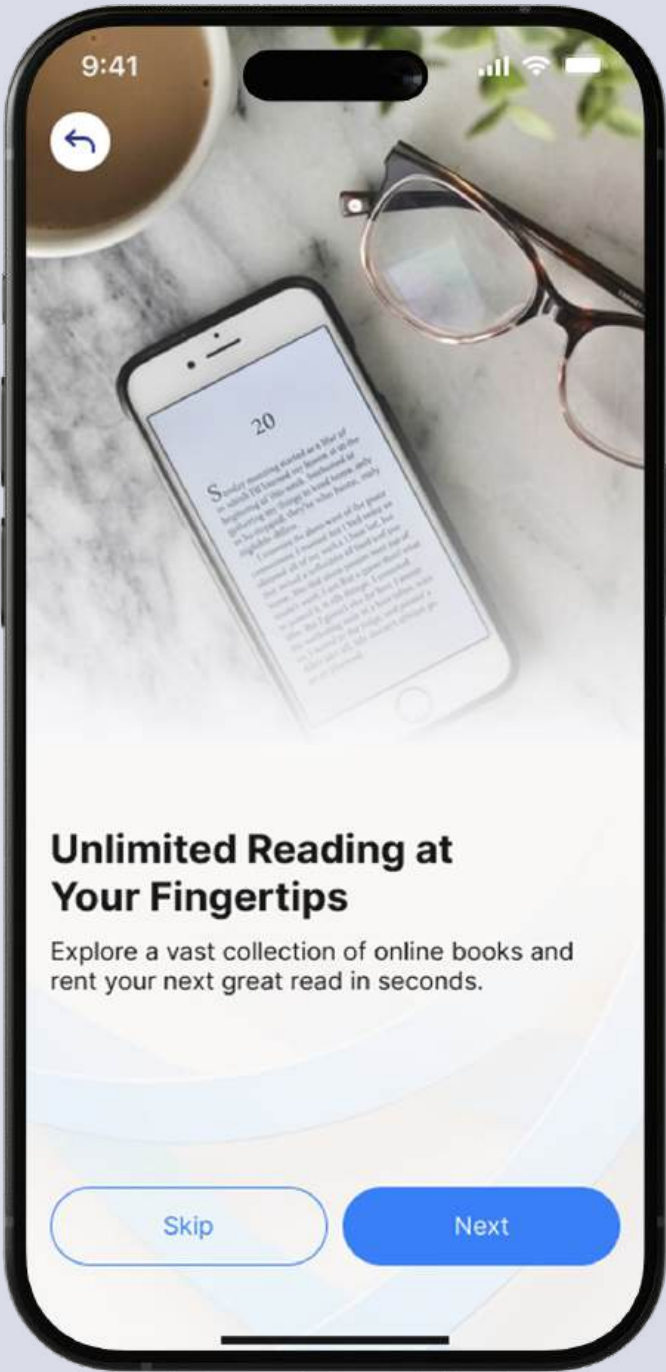
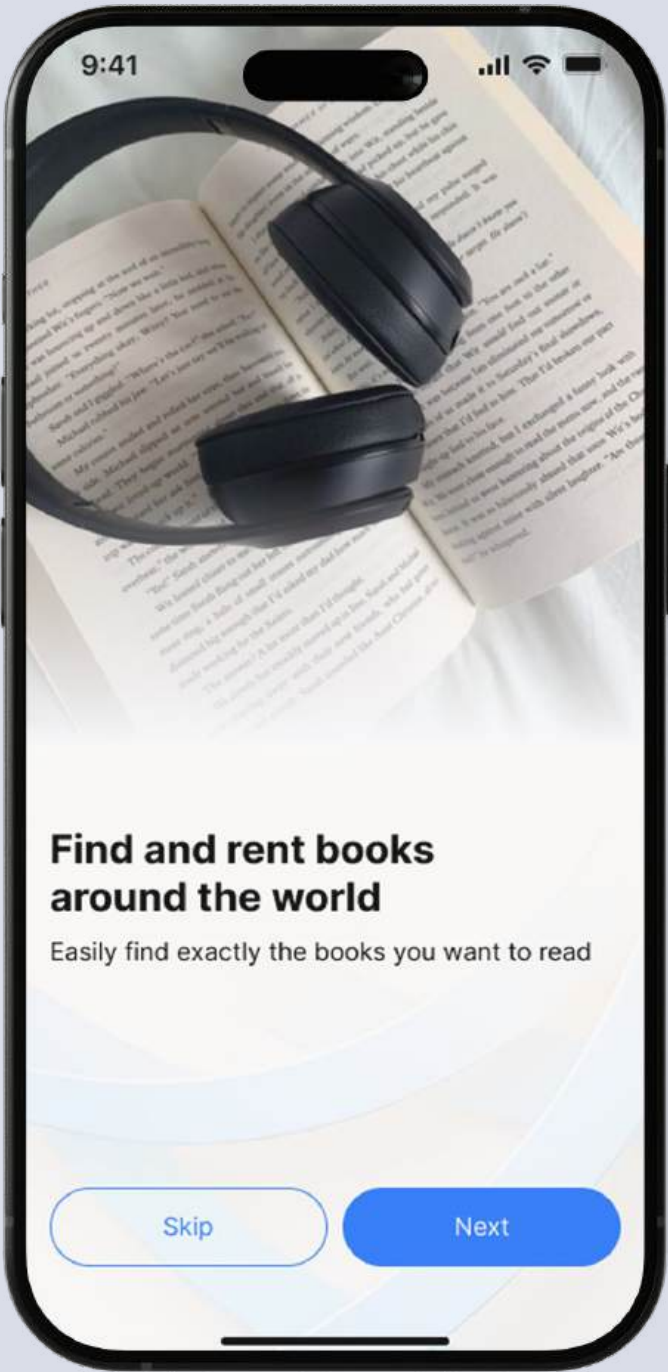


UI Screens

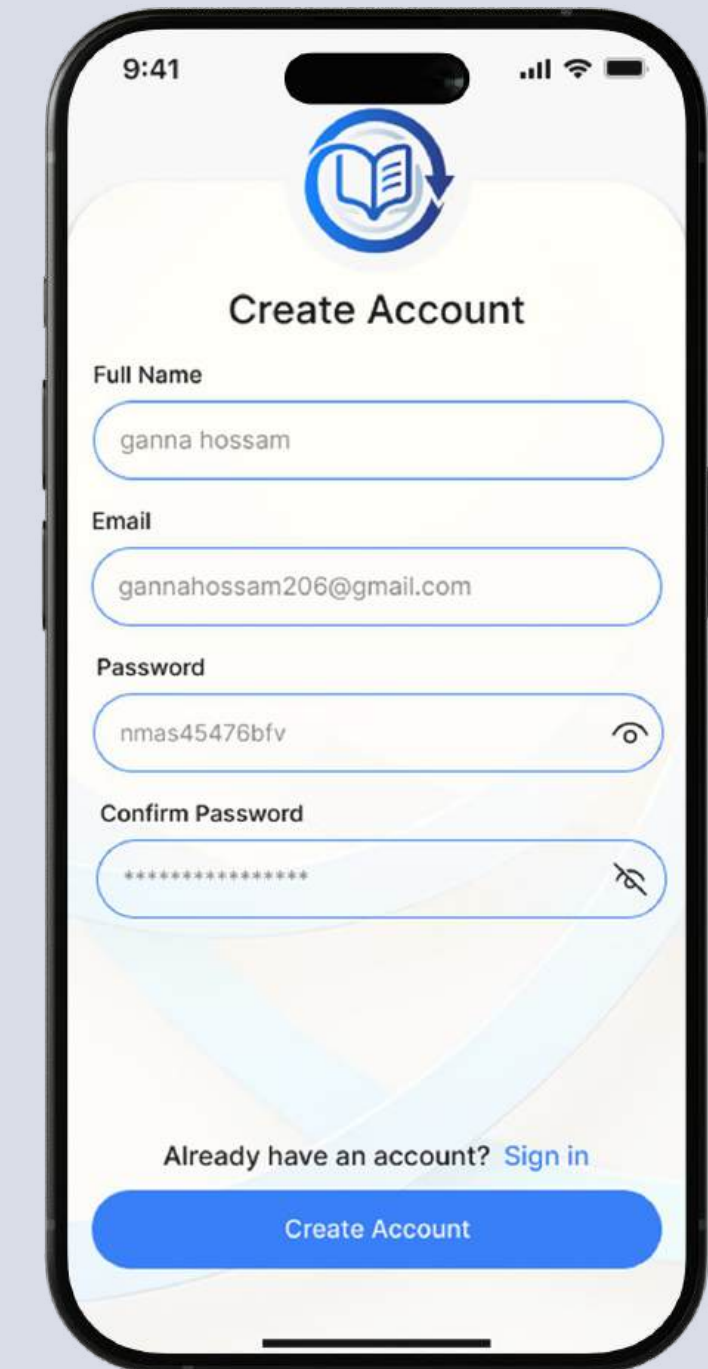
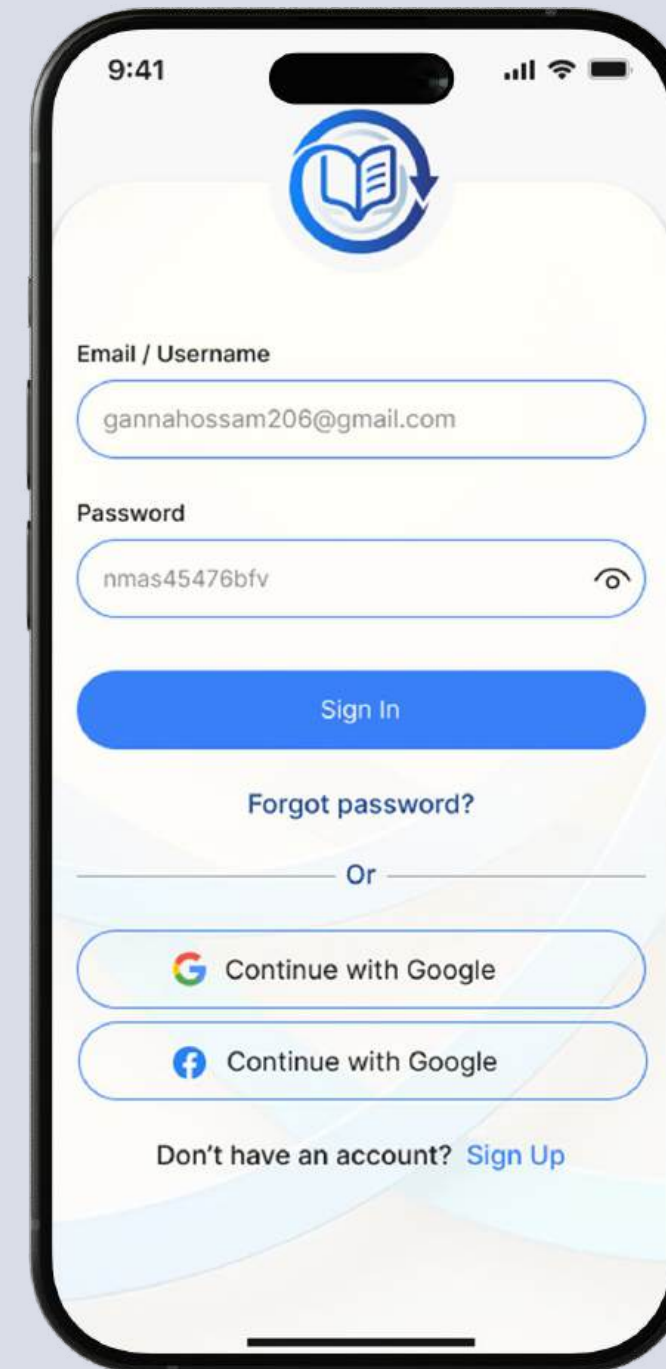
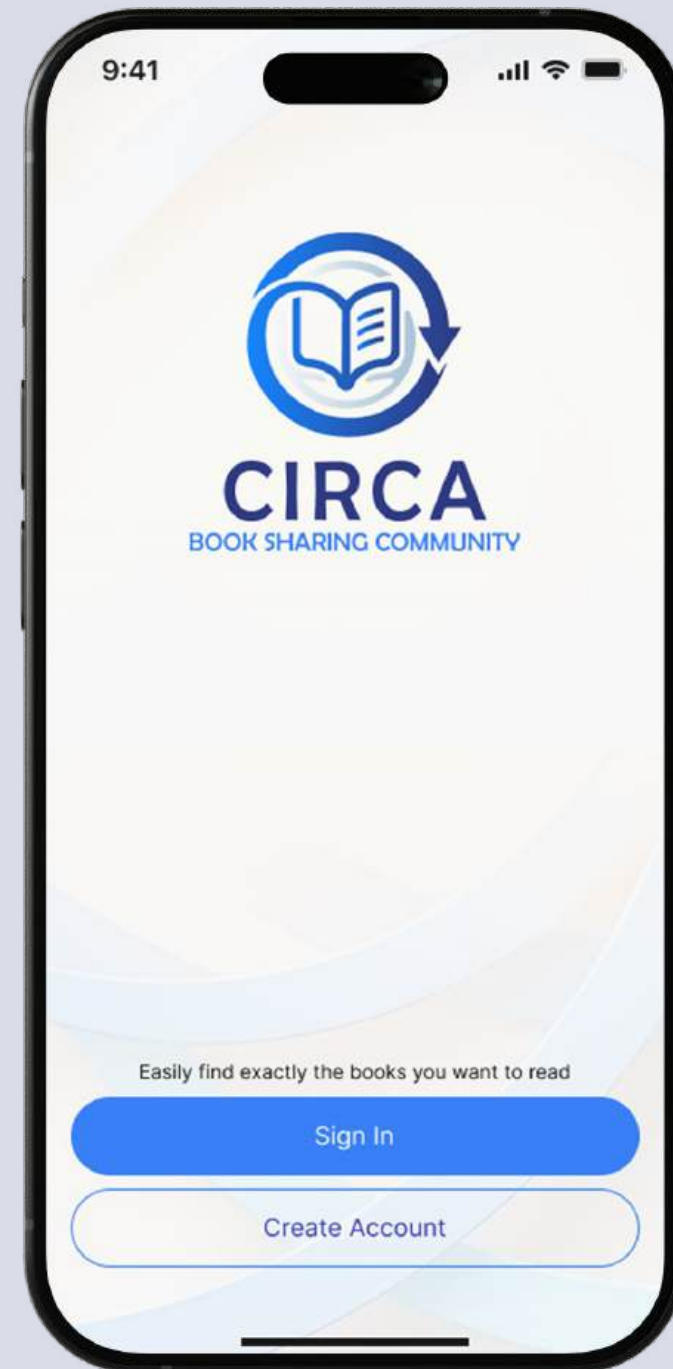
Splash Screen



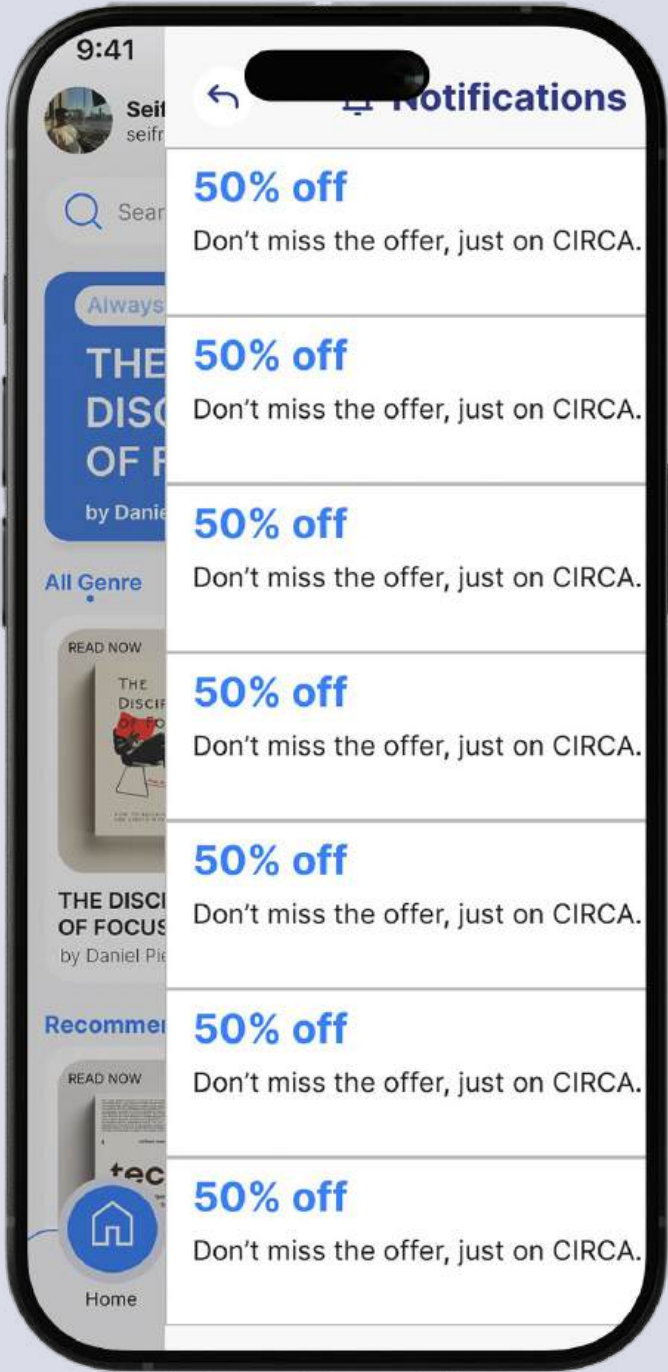
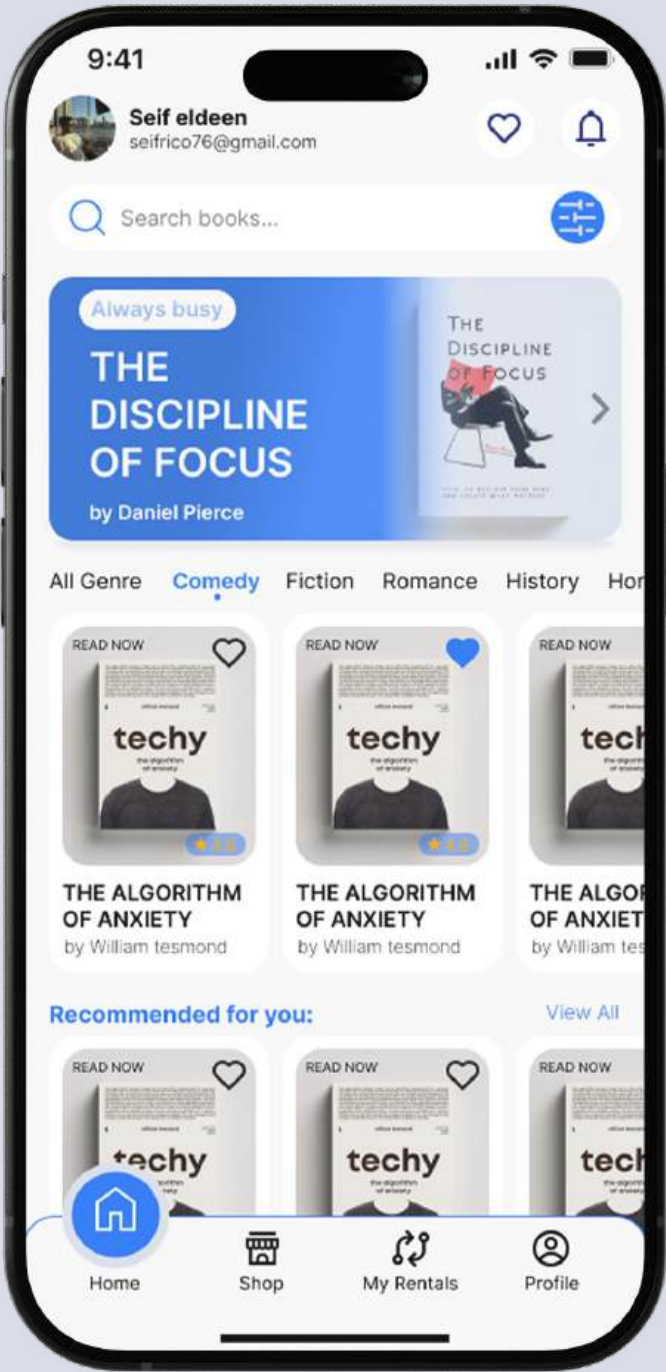
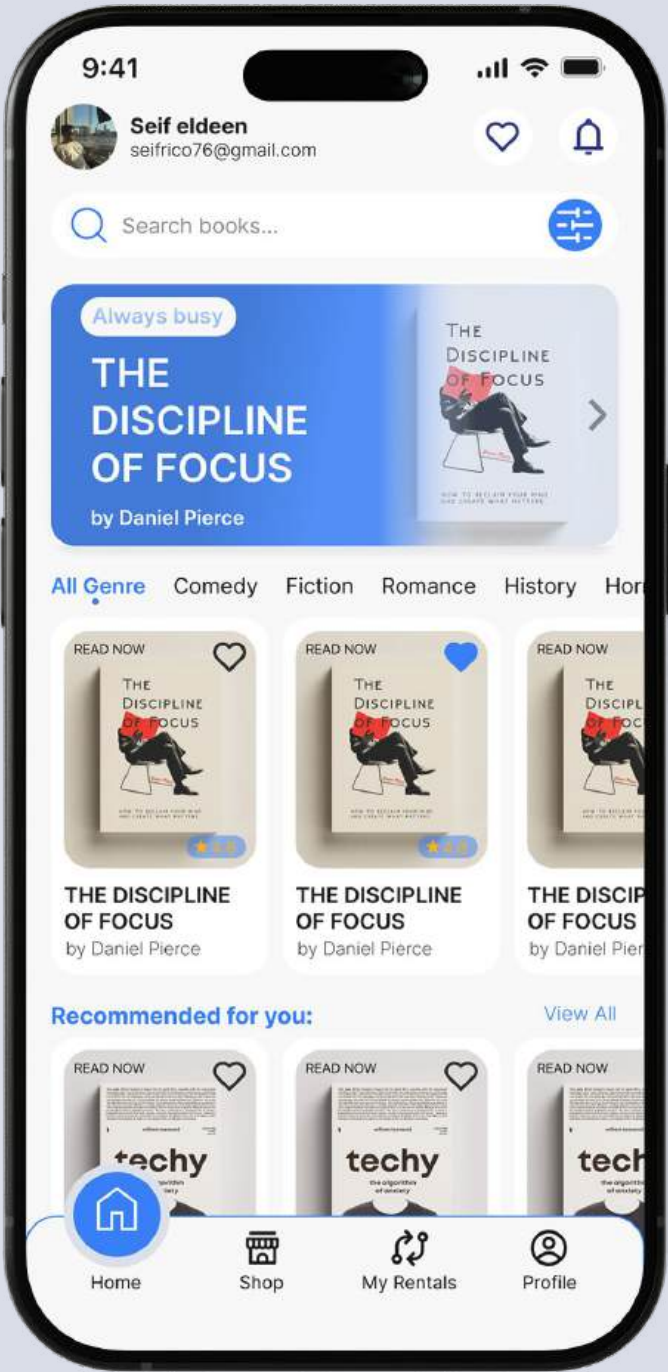
Onboarding Screens



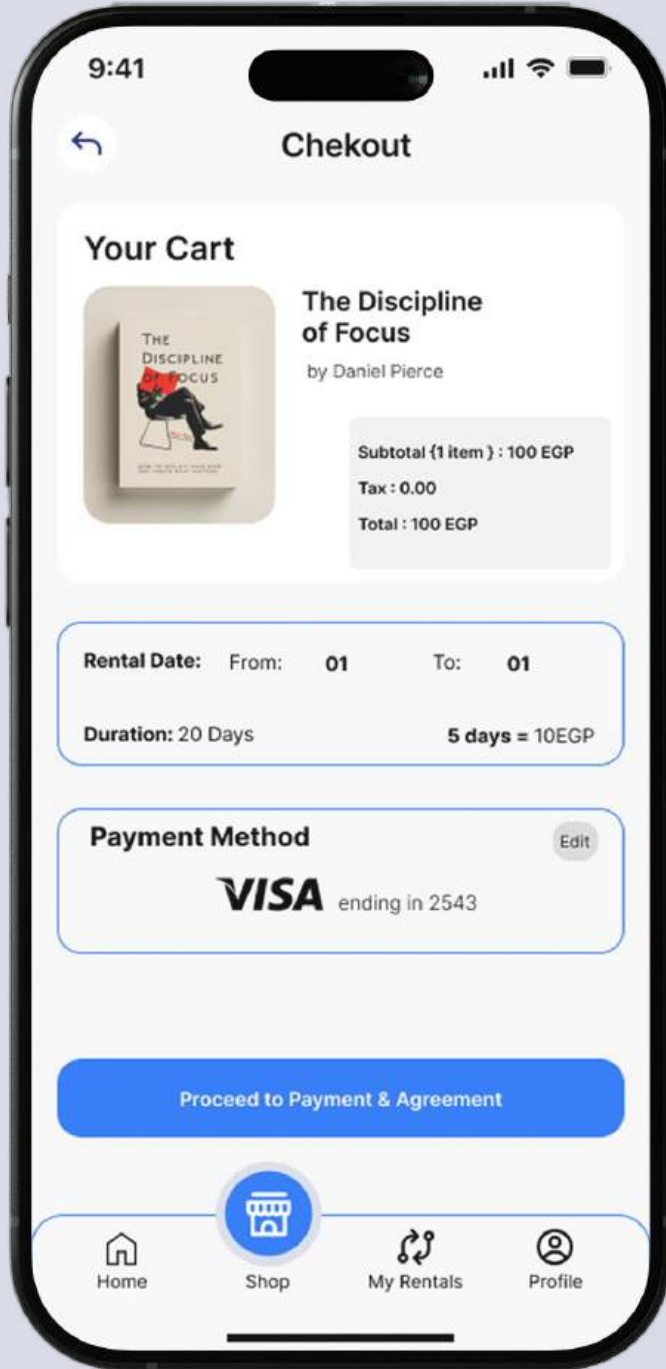
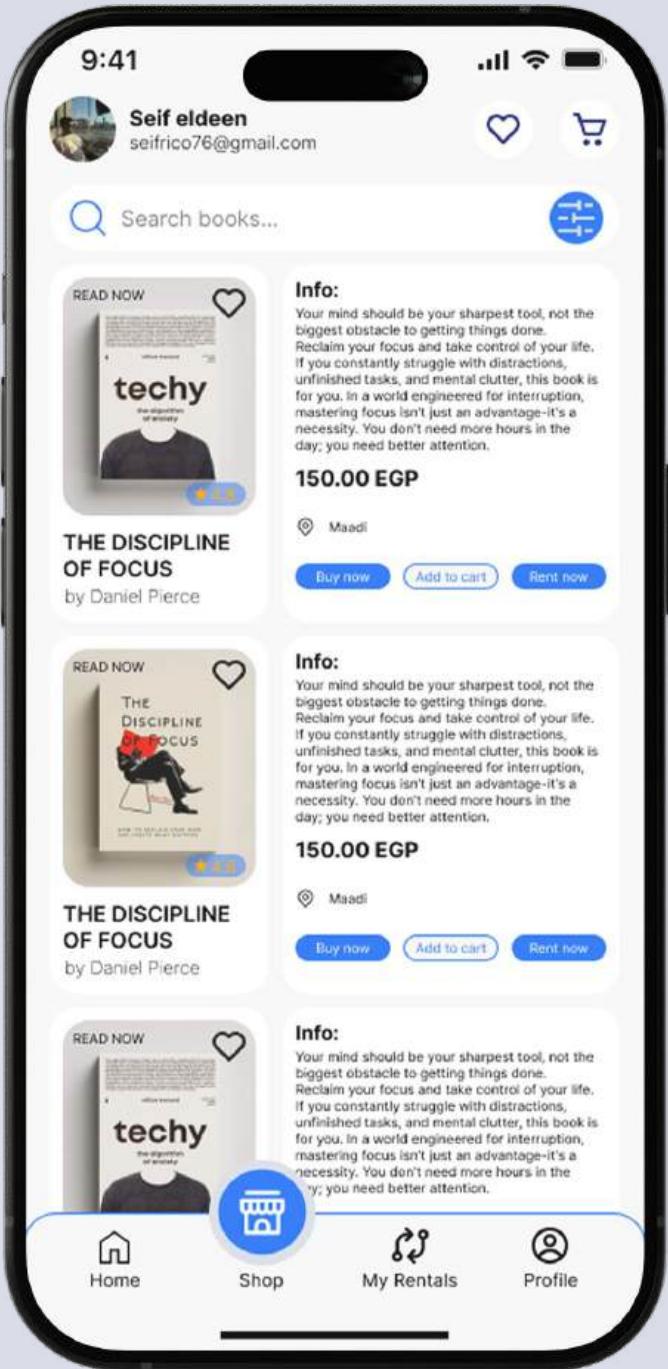
Sign in/Sign Up Screens



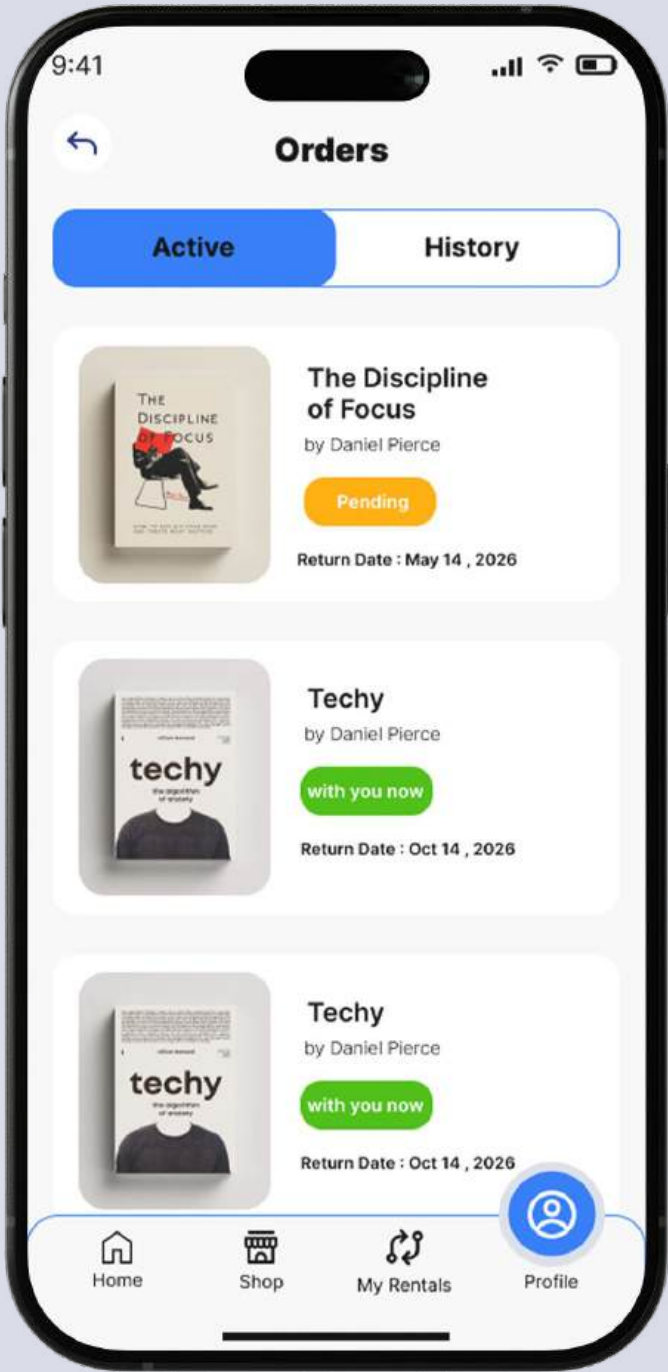
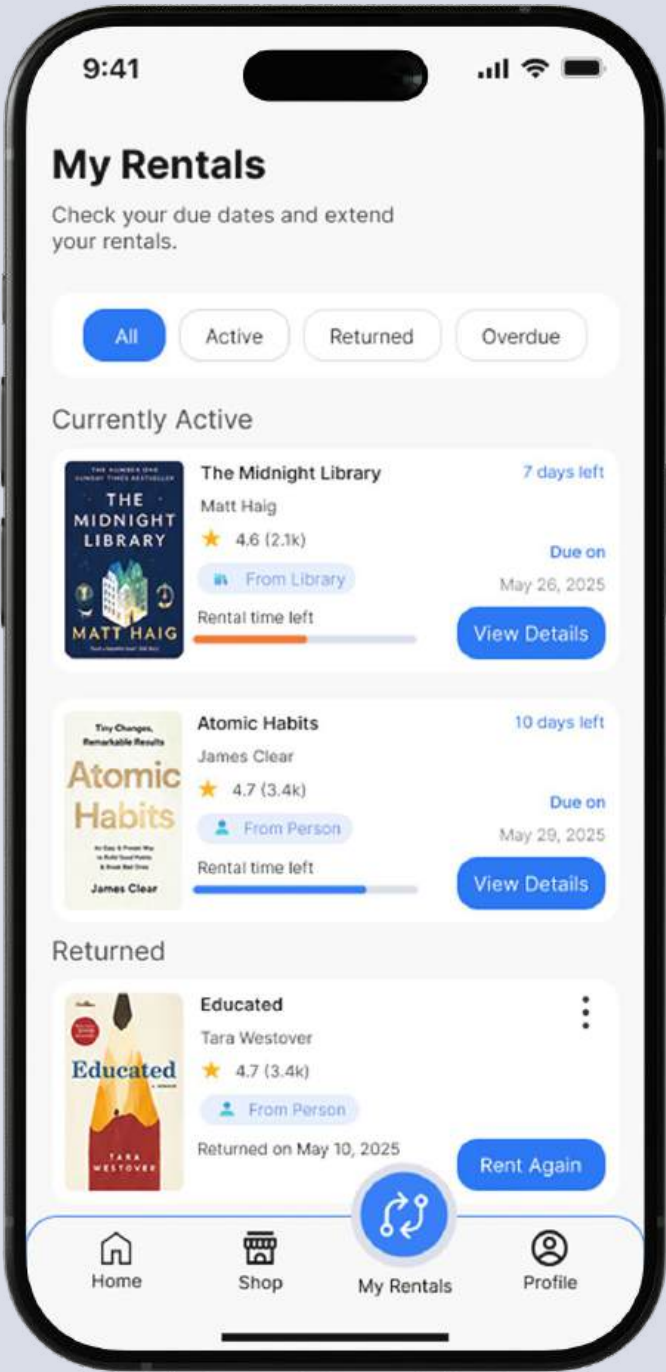
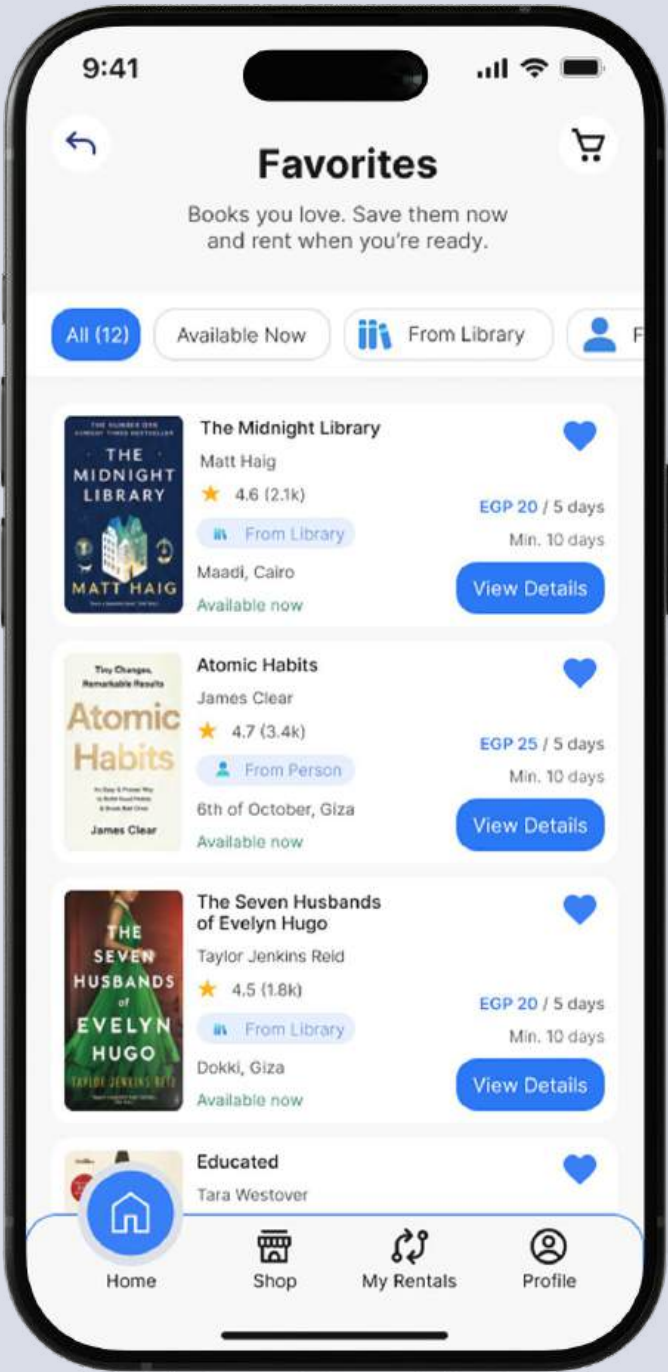
Home Screens



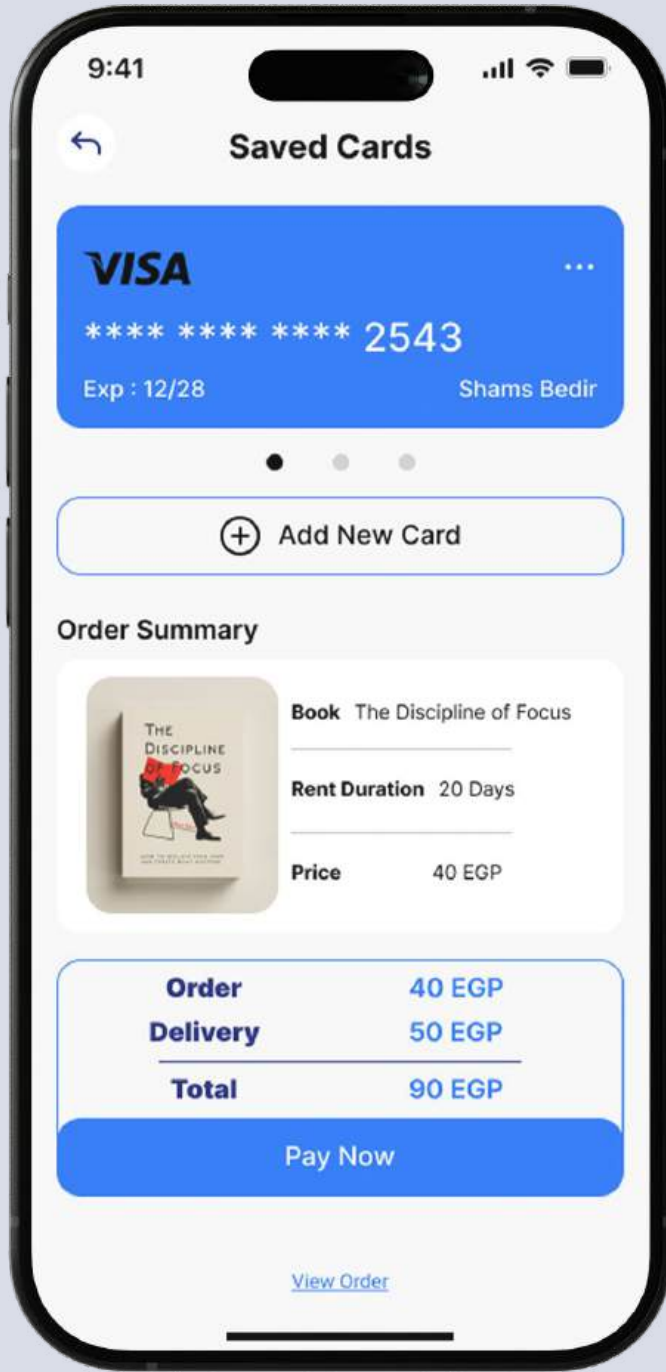
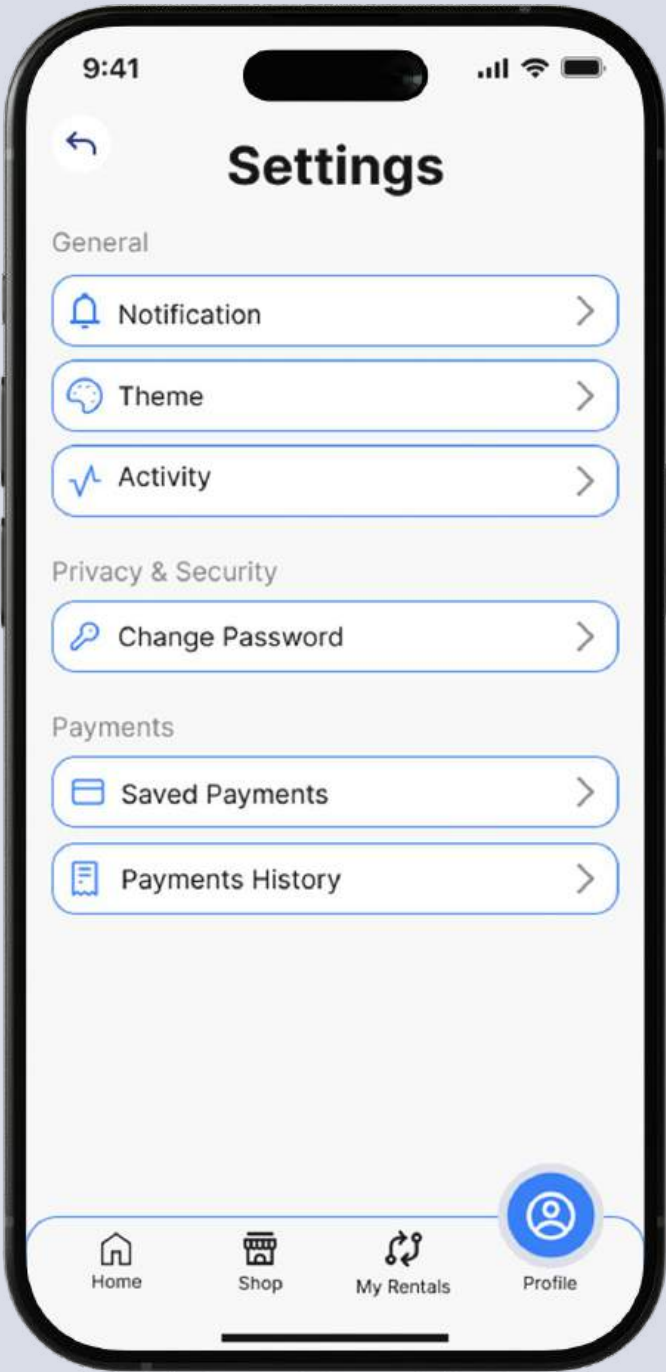
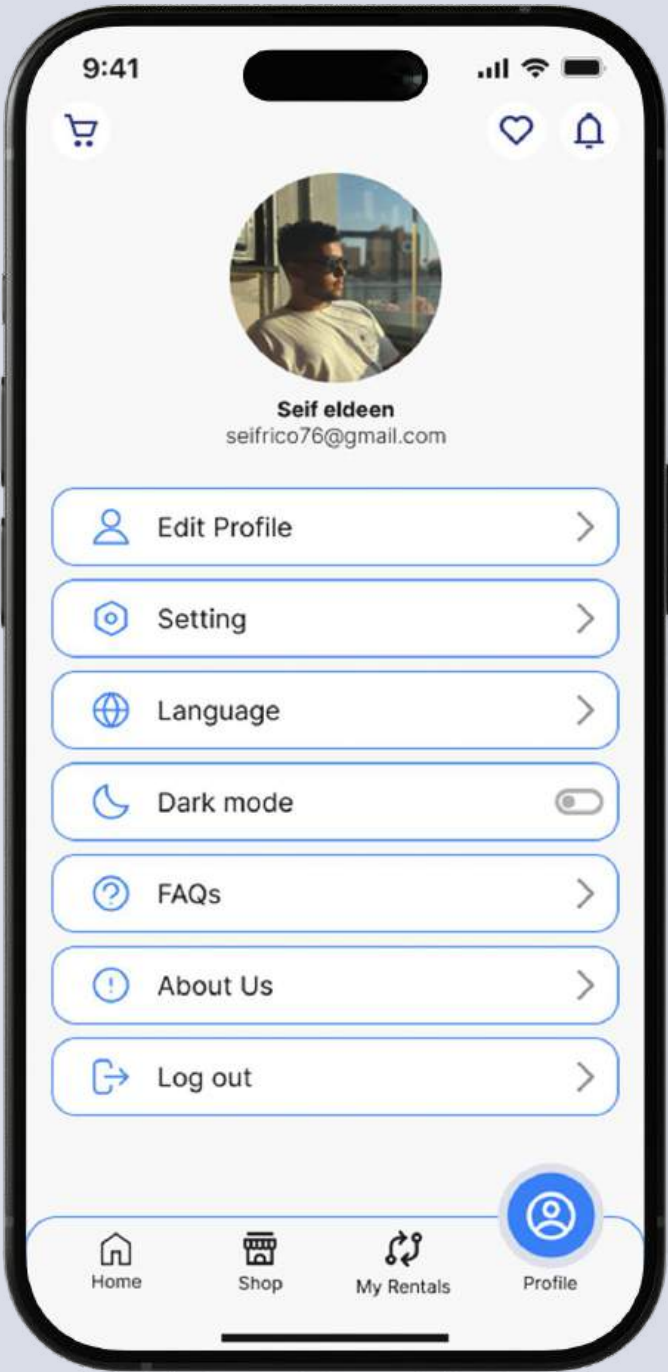
Buying/renteing flow Screens



Tracking Screens



Profile Screens



Thank You !

Presented by Team Circa